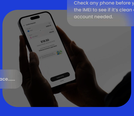
Buy and sell phones without the fear.



Find verified phones near you, with secure payments and Registry checks that help you buy from strangers safely.



Check any phone before you buy. Enter the IMEI to see if it's clean or flagged — no account needed.

Get to buy and sell in peace...

Every device on Payless is checked against a stolen-phone registry before you ever meet the seller. No hidden risk, no guesswork.

Check a Phone → Start selling

The Problem

Buying a used phone in Nigeria is a gamble.

You meet a stranger, hand over cash, and hope for the best. There's no way to know if the phone in your hand was stolen last week in another city — carriers don't share that information across networks, and by the time a police report goes through, the phone has already been resold three times.



The result: honest buyers unknowingly fund theft, and honest sellers get treated with the same suspicion as thieves.

The Solution

Two things, working together. By payless

Product 01

Registry — Free, for everyone. By payless

A public record where anyone can report a lost or stolen phone in seconds, and anyone can check a phone before buying it. No account needed to search. It takes the IMEI number (the phone's serial number) and tells you clean, or flagged.

Get Started →

Product 02

Marketplace — Where you buy and sell. By payless

A public record where anyone can report a lost or stolen phone in seconds, and anyone can check a phone before buying it. No account needed to search. It takes the IMEI number (the phone's serial number) and tells you clean, or flagged.

Get Started →

How It Works

Get To Understand.

How the Registry Works.

Lost your phone? Enter its IMEI (dial *#06# to find it) and Payless flags it instantly. You'll get a secret 3-word phrase — keep it safe. It's your key to clear the flag later if you get the phone back. From that moment, anyone who checks that IMEI sees it's stolen.

Step 1 Enter the IMEI number. That's the phone's serial number — dial *#06# on any phone to find it.

Step 2 Get a secret phrase. Three random words, generated instantly. This is your key to update the report later.

Step 3 The phone is flagged immediately. Anyone who checks that IMEI from this point on sees it's stolen.

Step 4 Found your phone? Clear the flag. Use your secret phrase to mark it safe again — no office visit, no waiting.

Before you buy, enter the phone's IMEI (dial *#06# to find it) and Payless checks it against the registry instantly. Clean means it's safe to buy. Flagged means walk away — no forms, no waiting.

How the Marketplace Works

Find a phone for sale near you and pay — your money is held safely, not sent to the seller yet. Meet at a trusted local shop to inspect the phone in person. Happy with it? Release payment on the spot. Not happy? Walk away, no money lost.

Step 1 Find a phone near you. Browse listings in your city — every one already checked against the registry.

Step 2 Pay, and your money is held. Not the seller's, not ours — held safely until you confirm the phone is what you paid for.

Step 3 Meet at a trusted location. A nearby partner shop, not a random street corner.

Step 4 Inspect, then release payment. Only when you're happy does the seller get paid.

List your phone free in minutes, get matched with a nearby buyer, meet at a trusted local shop, and get paid the moment they confirm.

Why Payless?

The safer way to buy and sell phones.

Buying and selling phones without the risk. Your money stays safe until you're satisfied, every trade happens face-to-face at a trusted shop, and listing is free.

Check a Phone → Start selling

- No listing fees. Selling costs nothing upfront.
- Meet in person, not blind. Every trade happens at a real shop, not a stranger's doorstep.
- Your money is protected. Payment only releases after you've checked the phone.
- Stolen phones lose their value. Because buyers can check before they pay, stolen devices become hard to sell — which is the whole point.
- Free to check, always. Anyone, anywhere, can look up a phone before buying — even outside the marketplace.

100% Free IMEI Checks



Flag a stolen phone in under 60 seconds — no forms, no waiting.

12-hour Buyer Protection Window

About Us

Built for how phones actually get bought and sold here.



Paul Dube
Co-Founder, CEO.



Ngbede Sawa
Co-Founder, CTO.



Agamwuta Martina
Co-Founder, Lead Designer.

> Payless started with a simple observation: phone theft isn't really a hardware problem, it's an information problem. A stolen phone works exactly the same as a clean one — the only thing missing is a way for the next buyer to know the difference.
>
> We built Payless to close that gap. It's free to check a phone, free to report one stolen, and built to work reliably even on a slow connection at a busy market stall. We started in Ilorin and we're growing city by city — because trust works best when it's local, and a face-to-face handshake still beats any app.

FAQ Section

Got questions?

Everything you need to know about checking, buying, and selling safely on Payless — no crypto jargon, we promise.

- Is Payless free?
 - Payless started with a simple observation: phone theft isn't really a hardware problem, it's an information problem. A stolen phone works exactly the same as a clean one — the only thing missing is a wa
- Do I need a crypto wallet or anything technical?
- How do I check if a phone is stolen?
- What if I have a problem during a trade?
- What if my phone gets found after I've flagged it stolen?
- Which cities is Payless in?

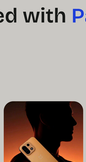
Use Payless Now!!!

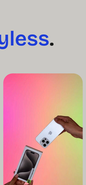
Get started with Payless.

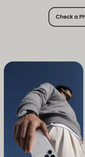
Check a phone, list one for sale, or just see what's nearby — no account required to browse.

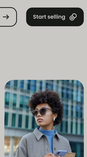
Check a Phone → Start selling











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